

Symphony had been completed in Linz in 1866. (A successor, dating from 1869 but then rejected by him, has—bizarrely—been given the posthumous designation No. 0.) The work was subsequently and repeatedly revised, like most of the great cycle to come—a process partly of self-criticism, but also often of Bruckner's taking on board advice from other musicians, advice that was usually well-meaning but often completely misguided. There was a perception that he was a Wagnerian symphonist, with little appreciation of the engaging spirit of Austrian country dance that he adopted in his work. There was also insufficient understanding of the fact that Bruckner's immense, powerful orchestral climaxes related more to the layered sonorities of the organ than to Wagner's sophisticated blending. Today, later Wagnerian-influenced “revisions” of the symphonies by others are rightly regarded as spurious.



SKETCH FOR SYMPHONY NO. 9

The last years of Bruckner's life were largely given over to the composition of his Ninth Symphony, which was unfinished at the time of his death.